

# Classroom Accommodations Checklist

Evidence-based accommodations for autistic students in inclusive classrooms

## Sensory Accommodations

- Preferential seating away from high-traffic areas
- Permission to use noise-cancelling headphones
- Access to a sensory break area or calm corner
- Dimmer lighting or natural light where possible
- Fidget tools allowed at desk (stress ball, chewable pencil topper)
- Warning before unexpected loud sounds (fire drills, assemblies)

## Communication Accommodations

- Extra processing time before requiring a response (5–10 seconds)
- Instructions given both verbally and in writing
- Visual schedule posted and referred to consistently
- Preferred communication method respected (writing, device, gesture)
- One instruction at a time rather than multi-step verbal instructions
- Pre-teaching new vocabulary before introducing it in class

## Academic Accommodations

- Extended time on tests and assignments
- Reduced number of problems (same content, less quantity)
- Graphic organizers and visual supports for writing tasks
- Access to typed responses instead of handwritten work
- Breaking large projects into smaller steps with interim deadlines
- Open-book or open-notes access for exams

## Social & Behavioural Accommodations

- Advance notice of transitions between activities
- Choice between group work and independent work where possible
- Clear, consistent classroom rules with visual reminders
- Private check-ins rather than public redirection
- Lunch or break buddy system available (not mandatory)
- Regular positive reinforcement for effort, not just performance

## Notes — Additional Accommodations Needed

*Note any additional accommodations agreed at the IEP meeting:*

*This checklist is a guide only. Accommodations should be tailored to each individual student's IEP, reviewed regularly, and adjusted based on progress and feedback from the student, family, and school team.*